

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

To Moroccans, Grasp at Hope Is Worth Risk

Soaring Unemployment Drives Young to Leave

By BEN HUBBARD
and AIDA ALAMI

FNIDEQ, Morocco — When King Mohammed VI of Morocco addressed his people last Wednesday to commemorate his 27th year on the throne, he spoke hopefully of his North African nation’s future.

Morocco, he said, is safe and stable, with a growing economy making great strides in tourism, investment and manufacturing.

“This is a pivotal moment in our nation’s development,” the 62-year-old monarch said. “A time when confidence and optimism should prevail over despair and frustration.”

Over the next two days, however, tens of thousands of his citizens tried to escape the country. Driven by a bleak sense of their prospects in Morocco, they braved confrontations with the police and dangerous swims in the sea to reach the Spanish territory of Ceuta, hoping for better lives.

“I tried to work and have a job and make a living, but there is nothing for me here,” said Mohammed Kinani, a 21-year-old construction worker, who had been forced back to Morocco. “If I don’t leave this country, there is nothing that will save me.”

Mr. Kinani was part of a sudden exodus that began on Thursday when 50,000 to 60,000 migrants began forcing their way into Ceuta, a tiny Spanish territory on the North African coast. By Saturday, many of the migrants had left, lacking food and water, and the Spanish security forces expelled others, but not before the crisis had given far-right politicians across Europe new ammunition to blast their opponents’ views on immigration.

The Spanish authorities said on Sunday that they had recorded 72 deaths during the crisis. The Moroccan government reported 11 deaths. Both sides said most of the deaths were from drowning.

Before the startling scenes of chaos at the border, the Moroccan government had much to celebrate: investments in logistics and industry, preparations to co-host the men’s World Cup in 2030 and strong relations with President Trump.

Continued on Page A7

RIGHT TURN Europe’s tough tone on Ceuta shows how attitudes have changed since 2015. PAGE A7



Migrants returning to Morocco on Sunday after up to 60,000 entered Ceuta, a Spanish territory that shares a border with the country.

SERGEY PONOMAREV FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Trump Pushes No-Bid Deals On Polar Fleet

This article is by **Christopher Flavelle, Andrea Fuller and Nicholas Nehamas.**

Late one night last August, Alexander Stubb, the president of Finland, was at his summer residence two hours west of Helsinki when his phone rang. On the other end of the line was President Trump, calling with a request.

He wanted to buy a fleet of massive ships designed to cut through Arctic ice.

Mr. Trump had long fixated on these hulking vessels, known as polar icebreakers. He viewed them as crucial to dominating the Arctic, where rising temperatures have put key shipping lanes and vast mineral wealth up for grabs. And he was incensed that the United States possessed far fewer than Russia.

Two months later, Mr. Trump and Mr. Stubb were sitting in the Oval Office to announce a deal for 11 icebreakers, worth almost \$7 billion, to be built by shipyards in both countries.

The arrangement was unusual

Continued on Page A10

Free Child Care May Cost the City Billions More

By ELIZA SHAPIRO

Mayor Zohran Mamdani’s vision for a free child care system for all New York City children under 5 could cost much more than he estimated, according to a report released on Monday.

A new model developed by the Center for New York City Affairs, a nonpartisan research organization affiliated with the New School, estimated that the proposed program would cost \$9 billion annually, with an average cost per child of around \$27,000.

That’s about \$5 billion more than the city spent on child care in 2025.

City Hall has not yet released its own cost model. As a candidate, Mr. Mamdani said he thought it

Projection of \$9 Billion a Year Far Surpasses Mamdani’s Figure

would cost about \$6 billion per year to create a free, universal child care system for children as young as 6 weeks, regardless of family income. The city currently offers free pre-K for 3-year-olds and 4-year-olds, with limited seats for 2-year-olds starting this fall.

The mayor used the \$6 billion figure to argue that the state would need to raise taxes on New York’s highest earners to pay for more seats.

Free child care is by far the most ambitious, complex and ex-

pensive piece of Mr. Mamdani’s push to expand the city’s safety net. The new projection underscores just how difficult it could be to find the money to fund even part of his plan at a moment when families across the city have cited the soaring cost of child care as a primary reason they are struggling to afford life in New York.

But the center’s research suggests that it would be next to impossible for Mr. Mamdani to make good on his promise without receiving billions of dollars in new revenue from the state or the federal government, or perhaps both, said Lauren Melodia, the director of the center’s economic and fiscal policy work and one of the authors of the report.

The roughly \$3 billion gap be-

Continued on Page A14



DAVE SANDERS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A report from the Center for New York City Affairs could complicate the mayor’s ambitious plans.

Democratic Socialists at Odds On Whether to Tone It Down

By KELLEN BROWNING

CHICAGO — When a leader of the Democratic Socialists of America recently appeared on “Fox News Sunday” and enthusiastically affirmed the group’s platform — including goals such as eliminating the U.S. Senate and working toward abolishing pris-

ons — Democratic strategists wrung their hands and Republicans licked their lips.

Acknowledging such aims, both parties predicted, could hinder progressive candidates and other Democrats painted with an extremist brush in the midterm elections.

At the D.S.A.’s national summit in Chicago over the weekend, many democratic socialists who had seen the Fox interview felt something different: pride.

“You’re going to have to constantly push and advocate for things that people don’t think, until they think it,” said Chanpreet Singh, a D.S.A. leader from Seattle.

Hundreds of members of the group, the country’s largest socialist organization, gathered in Chicago at a moment of surging political influence, some wearing bright red shirts, swapping labor-strike tips with their “comrades,”

Continued on Page A16



JAMIE KELTER DAVIS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Some in the D.S.A. are happy to push for positions that many Americans consider radical.

Michigan Senate Race Is a Weather Vane for Democrats’ Future

By REID J. EPSTEIN
and SAM EASTER

Democrats’ nastiest, most expensive Senate primary will culminate on Tuesday in Michigan, a pivotal midterm battleground where an insurgent progressive is looking to defeat an establishment-backed moderate in a contest serving as a referendum on the party’s future.

The race between Representative Haley Stevens and Dr. Abdul El-Sayed, a former public health

official, is charged by tensions over Israel, how to fight President Trump and the G.O.P., and what makes a candidate electable. The result will factor into the fight for Senate control in November, and may have ramifications that extend to the next presidential contest.

While polls conducted the last month have shown uncertainty in the competition, several recent public surveys showed Dr. El-Sayed leading, and he is increasingly seen by Democrats as the fa-

A Tense Battle Between the Left and Center

vorite as voters prepare to make their picks. In the final stretch, the candidates are speaking about each other in sharply critical terms. Their supporters can be even more severe.

“It’s the threats. It’s the ugliness,” said Representative Debbie Dingell of Michigan, a Democrat

THE WEATHER

Today, partly sunny, less humid, high 84. **Tonight**, partly cloudy, low 72. **Tomorrow**, partly cloudy, a thunderstorm in spots in the afternoon, high 83. Weather map, Page B8.

BLANCHE MEMOS LEAVE LOOPHOLES FOR TRUMP FUND

NOT LEGALLY BINDING

Holdouts Are Appeased, Paving Way for A.G.’s Confirmation

By DEVLIN BARRETT

WASHINGTON — A pair of documents issued by the acting attorney general, Todd Blanche, that narrow or dissolve aspects of a deal to resolve President Trump’s lawsuit against the I.R.S. have met the demands of two Republican holdouts.

Senators Thom Tillis of North Carolina and John Cornyn of Texas refused to support Mr. Blanche’s nomination unless he committed in writing to dropping a \$1.8 billion fund funneling taxpayer money to the president’s allies and putting stricter limits on a part of the plan that provides sweeping protections to Mr. Trump and those in his inner circle from I.R.S. audits.

Critics, however, say the written assurances are a political solution to a political problem, rather than a legally binding document.

“This case was flagrantly illegal from the start and they’re clearly trying to find a political way out of it that gets the attorney general confirmed without giving up their legal rights to actually enforce this illegal settlement,” said Matthew Platkin, a Democratic former New Jersey attorney general. He is now in private practice, representing various people suing over the fund.

The Justice Department did not respond to a request for comment.

For weeks, Mr. Blanche had resisted putting into writing his testimony to lawmakers that Mr. Trump’s fund was truly dead or that the tax protections applied more narrowly than the language in his initial order suggested. But on Sunday night, the administration relented.

One of the two documents Mr. Blanche released stated that the order creating the fund “is rescinded and shall have no force or effect.” The second document limits a provision that gave broad protection to Mr. Trump, his relatives, and “related or affiliated individuals” from tax audits. The new written order from Mr. Blanche says that the provision only covers the president, two of his sons and his company, and that it applies “only retroactively.”

Mr. Tillis and Mr. Cornyn said in a statement that the documents assuaged their concerns, ending an intraparty stalemate that had stalled Mr. Blanche’s confirmation process for days. The senators added that they believed the department had “acknowledged in a binding written order” that the audit protections were limited, “addressing concerns that multiple of our Republican colleagues share.”

Continued on Page A13

MEDDLING President Trump has imperiled a number of cases at the Justice Department. PAGE A13

INTERNATIONAL A4-11

Asia’s Lonely Tourist Hot Spots

Some towns and cities that rely on European travelers are suffering as high airfares and disruptions to Mid-east hubs keep many away. PAGE A4

Iran Feels It Has Upper Hand

By expanding the arena of fighting, Tehran sent a warning about the dangers of a widening war. PAGE A8

OBITUARIES B11-12

A Top Nation of Islam Official

John Ali, 98, clashed with Malcolm X and was suspected by some of playing a role in his 1965 assassination. PAGE B11

SPORTS B6-10

Used to a Big N.F.L. Challenge

After six years as Browns coach, Kevin Stefanski is prepared to try to turn around the Falcons. PAGE B9

Surf’s Up, and Risky, in Alaska

The tidal bore that rockets up the Turnagain Arm can carry a surfer six miles; it can also kill. PAGE B6



NATIONAL A12-17, 20

A Whiff of Controversy

A Florida town’s concerns about polluted water — and the pervasive smell of cannabis — are aimed at a giant producer of medical marijuana. PAGE A12

A.I. Fast Tracks a Folk Ballad

After a man was killed by ICE, technology helped write a corrido, a tradition of marking tragedy through song. PAGE A14

ARTS C1-6

A Ballerina’s Newest Move

Misty Copeland, recently retired from American Ballet Theater, is curating a festival at the Joyce Theater. PAGE C1

SCIENCE TIMES D1-8

The Perils of a ‘High-T’ Army

A new U.S. military policy raises concerns about testosterone’s effect on aggression in some men. PAGE D1

Daylight Saving’s True Cost

Scientists have documented the effects of the twice-yearly time shift on public health and the economy. PAGE D1



BUSINESS B1-5

Bracing for Winter Fuel Prices

Across Europe, reserves of natural gas are lagging, meaning higher costs for households and businesses. PAGE B1

SpaceX May Get Bumpier

On Thursday, employees and insiders will be released from their first stock “lockup.” Let the selling begin. PAGE B1

OPINION A18-19

Maureen Ryan

PAGE A19

